

Emotions and Literary Genres in the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* and the New Testament

A Contribution to Form History and Historical Psychology

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Abstract

This essay argues that there is a relationship between the presentation and evaluation of emotions, on the one hand, and the genre(s) in which these are present, on the other hand. A significant difference can be observed between narrative and paraenetic texts. In narrative texts, we find a plurality of emotions that are evaluated in a differentiated manner, accepted as reality, and linked to the body. In paraenetic texts, emotions are often reduced to a single alternative. Great authorities urge one to avoid these emotions in future, whereas narratives tend to give the reader the opportunity to take one's distance from them. Different anthropological possibilities of perceiving and coping with reality correspond to the different genres.

Keywords

emotion(s) – genre – *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* – New Testament – envy – anger – desire

Should we run away from emotions or avoid them entirely? Would it be best if they did not exist at all, or are they presupposed and evaluated as wholly normal forms of expression of our human existence? We can find both positions in classical literature. On the one hand, philosophical texts admonish us to control (moderate) emotions (thus the Aristotelian and Plutarchian position) or

* The author wishes to express her gratitude to Dr Brian McNeil for his accurate translation.

even to be free of emotions (thus the Stoic position).¹ On the other hand, we often encounter, as a matter of course, a plethora of emotions, or even an explosion of emotions (or of one particular emotion) in classical plays and novels.² This prompts the question of the connection between the textual presentation and evaluation of emotions and the genre(s) in which they are presented. The scholarly investigation of literary genres has a long tradition by now, but the investigation of emotions in classical antiquity is relatively new.³ Genres represent a variety of perspectives on life and the world. Their plurality is evidence of the human person's capacity for multiperspectivity. The question, therefore, is: Do the various perspectives also interpret emotions differently?

But what are we talking about when we speak about emotions? Before we take up the question of the connection between emotions and genre(s), I should like to look briefly at this serious problem: namely, 'emotion' is a modern term, and that the understanding of 'emotions' differs, as the linguist Anna Wierzbicka has shown in her cross-cultural work.⁴ The understanding of 'emotions' differs

- 1 See A.Vögtle, 'Affekt', in Th. Klauser et al. (eds.), *Reallexikon für Antike und Christentum* (Stuttgart: Hierseemann, 1950), vol. 1, pp. 164–65; M.C. Nussbaum, *The Therapy of Desire: Theory and Practice in Hellenistic Ethics* (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1994), vol. 2, esp. pp. 389–98; C. Gill, 'The Emotions in Greco-Roman Philosophy', in S.M. Braund and C. Gill (eds.), *The Passions in Roman Thought and Literature* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1997), pp. 6–9; J.M. Dillon, 'Metriopatheia and Apatheia: Some Reflections on a Controversy in Later Greek Ethics', in J.P. Anton and A. Preus (eds.), *Essays in Ancient Greek Philosophy* (Albany: State University of New York Press, 1983), vol. 2, pp. 508–509; M. Hossenfelder, *Stoa, Epikureismus und Skepsis* (Die Philosophie der Antike; GPh, 3; Munich: C.H. Beck, 1985), vol. 3, pp. 46–47.
- 2 See, among others, W.B. Stanford, *Greek Tragedy and the Emotions: An Introductory Study* (London: Routledge & Keagan Paul, 1983); Braund and Gill (eds.), *The Passions in Roman Thought and Literature*.
- 3 For recent studies of ancient philosophers' accounts of emotions, see particularly the bibliography in D. LaCourse Munteanu, 'Introduction. Emotion in Literature: Genre and Gender', in D. LaCourse Munteanu (ed.), *Emotion, Genre and Gender in Classical Antiquity* (London: Bristol Classical, 2011), p. 9 n. 1. The focus of this interesting book lies on the relation between genre and gender. On p. 2, D. LaCourse Munteanu asks the question we too are interested in: 'Does genre influence the way in which emotions are presented in a literary text ...?' See also D. LaCourse Munteanu, *Tragic Pathos: Pity and Fear in Greek Philosophy and Tragedy* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2012).
- 4 A. Wierzbicka, *Emotions across Languages and Cultures: Diversity and Universals* (Studies in Emotion and Social Interaction, 11; Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1999). In addition to the question of concepts, there is also the question of the universality of emotions. Here too, we must be cautious. Many historians, such as R. Boddice, have recently pointed 'to historical differences in the ways in which emotions themselves were conceptualized (as passions, e.g., centred in the heart, the spleen, and only latterly in the brain)'. See R. Boddice, 'The

even in modern languages that are close to each other in terms of their culture and their origin. As Wierzbicka's investigations have demonstrated, there is no real equivalent to the English term 'emotion' in French and German, and still less in Slavic languages such as Polish or Russian, or in remote languages such as Samoan.⁵ 'Emotion' is a more general term that has no equivalent in Biblical Hebrew or in Greek. That is why I prefer in my investigations to start from the Greek term *πάθη* and its subterms, which were employed in psychological discussions both in classical antiquity and in later times. *θυμός*, *ὄργή* and *ἐπιθυμία* – commonly translated by 'anger', 'envy', and 'desire' – are subterms of *πάθη* that were prominently discussed in texts of antiquity dealing with psychology. In what follows, I shall look more closely at these subterms in the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* and in the New Testament.

My investigation starts from the idea that there may be a relationship between the textual presentation and evaluation of emotions and the genre(s) in which they are presented. As for the genres, I will concentrate on *narratio* and *paraenesis* in the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* and the New Testament. My thesis is that narrative texts present emotions in a much more complex manner than *paraenesis*, which often reduces them to one single alternative. I shall explore reasons for this on three levels: in the differing genres, in the differing communicative functions vis-à-vis the reader, and in the anthropological possibilities of seeing and coping with reality. In what follows, I shall always proceed in three steps: First, I describe how emotions appear in narrative genres, then how they appear in paraenetic genres. In a third step, I compare what is said about the emotions in the two genres.

Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs

Let us first look at the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*. Within the macro-genre 'testament' or, more precisely, 'farewell discourse',⁶ three main subgenres come together in one single body of text:

Affective Turn: Historicizing the Emotions', in C. Tileagă and J. Byford (eds.), *Psychology and History: Interdisciplinary Explorations* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2014), pp. 150–51.

5 Wierzbicka, *Emotions*, pp. 2–3.

6 On this, see T. de Bruin, *The Great Controversy: The Individual's Struggle between Good and Evil in the Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs and in Their Jewish and Christian Contexts* (NTOA, 106; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 2015), pp. 36–42. M. Winter (*Das Vermächtnis Jesu und die Abschiedsworte der Väter* [FRLANT, 161; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht 1994], pp. 199–204) proposed the genre of 'Vermächtnisrede'.

1. narrative-biographical passages, looking back on the past;⁷
2. paraenetic passages, giving instructions for conduct;⁸ and
3. prophetic declarations about the future.⁹

In this paper, we shall focus on the first two subgenres.¹⁰

The Testament of Simeon

I

In a biographical retrospect, Simeon relates: 'And at that time I was *jealous* (ἐζήλωσα) of Joseph, because our father loved him. And I *set my liver* against him to kill him, because the prince of error sent the spirit of *jealousy* (πνεῦμα τοῦ ζήλου) and blinded my mind' (T. Sim. 2:6–7).¹¹ He goes on to speak of his *anger* (ὠργισθην) at Judah, who had sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites, 'because he had let him go alive' (T. Sim. 2:11), and says that he maintained his *anger* (ὀργιζόμενος) at him for five months (T. Sim 2:11). He thus speaks completely openly about his jealousy, about the hardening of his liver,¹² and about his enduring anger. The terms ζήλος and ὀργή are found regularly in the ancient lists of emotions,¹³ and the hardening of the liver is presented as a somatic expression and effect of anger. The punitive suffering is also somatic: His hand was withered for seven days. This suffering leads Simeon to the insight¹⁴ that this

7 E. von Nordheim, *Die Lehre der Alten, I. Das Testament als Literaturgattung im Judentum der hellenistisch-römischen Zeit* (ALGHJ, 13.1; Leiden: Brill, 1980), vol. 1, p. 15; de Bruin, *Controversy*, p. 43.

8 See also von Nordheim, *Lehre der Alten, I*, p. 15.

9 Their sequence is interchangeable and can be repeated at will, as von Nordheim, *Lehre der Alten, I*, pp. 229–32, has shown.

10 We interpret the text of the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* in its final form without distinguishing diachronically between different layers and independently of the hypothesis of a Jewish 'Grundschrift' with Christian interpolations or a Christian writing that draws on Jewish traditions. On these two tendencies in the interpretation of the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*, see H.D. Slingerland, *The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs: A Critical History of Research* (SBLMS, 21; Missoula, MT: Scholars, 1977).

11 Except where otherwise noted, the English translation of the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* is by M. de Jonge, in H.F.D. Sparks (ed.), *The Apocryphal Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon, 1984), pp. 505–600, making use of the literal translations in his footnotes.

12 According to *T. Reu.* 3:4, the spirit of strife is localized in the liver and the gall; according to *T. Naph.* 2:8, God created the liver 'for anger' and the gall 'for bitterness'. Psychology in classical antiquity saw a close connection between strife and anger.

13 T. Onuki, *Gnosis und Stoa: Eine Untersuchung zum Apokryphon des Johannes* (NTOA, 9; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1989), pp. 35–37.

14 This is the logical counterpart to the darkening of his understanding (νοῦς) by the prince of error and the spirit of jealousy in *T. Sim.* 2:7.

has happened to him because of Joseph. He turns in penitence to the Lord,¹⁵ and asks that his hand may be restored and that 'I might keep myself from all pollution and envy (φθόνου) and from all folly (ἀφροσύνης)' (T. Sim. 2:13). When he speaks to God in prayer, a process of insight takes place: Simeon 'realized' that what he had planned to do to Joseph 'in envy' (φθονήσας αὐτῷ) was wrong (T. Sim. 2:14).

In T. Sim. 4:1.4, between two paraenetic sections, we once again find a biographical-narrative section. It begins with a mention of the external effect of Simeon's emotional state: His father sees that he is 'sad' (σκυθρωπόν). The ancient psychology of emotions offers a differentiated description of the externally observable changes caused by the emotions.¹⁶ Simeon then explains his wretched state by telling his father: 'I am distressed in my liver' (T. Sim. 4:1).¹⁷ This is caused by the excessive mourning (ἐπένθουν) over the guilt he had incurred in the selling of Joseph (T. Sim. 4:2). He became conscious (ἔγνων) of this guilt when Joseph had him bound in Egypt, and he 'was not put out (οὐκ ἐλυπόμην)'.¹⁸ In T. Sim. 4:4, Simeon tells of Joseph's compassion, and of his mercy and his love for his brothers.

II

In the paraenetic sections in which the dying Simeon addresses words of admonition to his 'children', he charges them to be on their guard against 'the spirits of error and envy' (T. Sim. 3:1).¹⁹ This is justified by a reference to the power and the consequences of envy: 'For envy (φθόνος) dominates a man's whole mind and lets him neither eat nor drink nor do anything that is good. It is continually suggesting to him that he should kill the man that is envied; and the man that is envied continues to flourish, while the man that envies wastes away' (T. Sim 3:2–3). In a completely analogous way, we find in the *paraenesis* in T. Sim. 4:5–7 an appeal by Simeon to his children to 'beware of all jealousy (ζήλου) and (all) envy (φθόνου)', combined with a positive injunction for their conduct: They are

15 On fasting, see also the biographical retrospect within the *paraenesis* in T. Sim. 3:4.

16 The explanation given in T. Sim. 4:8–9 also speaks of how emotions attack the thinking and the understanding.

17 In T. Sim. 2:7 he had spoken of the hardening of his liver against Joseph.

18 This realization is depicted as a result of the humiliating and punitive treatment ('as a spy') he had endured.

19 In the biographical section, the justification in T. Sim. 2:7 speaks of the 'prince of error' (πλάνης); in T. Sim. 2:13–14, the patriarch speaks of 'envy' (φθόνος, φθονήσας). Here, as often in the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*, the biographical section functions as example for the *paraenesis*; see de Bruin, *Controversy*, p. 69, including n. 45.

to walk in simplicity of heart (T. Sim. 4:5).²⁰ This culminates in the appeal that each one should 'love his brother with a good heart', for this will make the 'spirit of envy' depart from them.²¹

III

If we now compare the biographical-narrative sections with the paraenetic sections, we notice immediately that the paraenetic sections concentrate strongly on the emotion of envy,²² while the biographical-narrative sections mention not only envy²³ but also fearlessness (T. Sim. 2:3), a lack of compassion (T. Sim. 2:4),²⁴ the liver that is unbending or hardened (T. Sim. 2:4,7; cf. 4:1),²⁵ jealousy (ἐξήλωσα, T. Sim. 2:6; cf. τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ ξήλου, T. Sim. 2:7), anger (ὠργίσθην, ὀργιζόμενος, T. Sim. 2:11), and grief (ἐπένθουν, T. Sim. 4:2; cf. οὐκ ἐλυπούμην, 4:3). There is thus a stronger differentiation here.²⁶

In the narrative sections, unlike the paraenetic passages, psychosomatic links are also specified: Simeon's heart was hard, his liver unbending, and his entrails devoid of compassion (T. Sim. 2:4).²⁷ Through God's intervention,²⁸ his anger leads to the withering of his right hand for a time (T. Sim. 2:12). His father

20 This is justified by the goal or prospect: 'so that God may give you also grace and glory and blessing on your heads, just as you saw in him [Joseph]' (T. Sim. 4:5). Joseph functions here as a justifying and motivating example, which is given additional depth by the biographical look back on Joseph's exemplary loving behaviour. What follows (T. Sim. 4:8–9; 5:1) is a justification of the *paraenesis* on a high level of abstraction – in a negative formulation at T. Sim. 4:8–9 and in a positive formulation at T. Sim. 5:1 (taking up T. Sim. 4:5b–6). The justification establishes a link between the narrative section and the *paraenesis*.

21 T. Sim. 4:7–9; a detailed justification is offered in T. Sim. 5:1. The formulation in T. Sim. 4:7 makes it clear that human beings are not determined by the spirit of envy in such a way that they have no free will of their own, since it is their love of the brethren that chases away the spirit of envy.

22 T. Sim. 4:5 speaks of ζήλος and φθόνος: 'Beware of all jealousy and (all) envy'.

23 Envy is mentioned *explicitly* for the first time in T. Sim. 2:13–14, and likewise in the brief biographical retrospective in T. Sim. 3:4. Envy is never mentioned explicitly in T. Sim. 4:1–4; nevertheless, manuscripts b, g, l, d, m, e give T. Sim. the heading: περὶ φθόνου.

24 This is also found in the *justification* in the *paraenesis* in T. Sim. 3:6.

25 According to H.M. Hollander and M. de Jonge, *The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs: A Commentary* (SVTP, 8; Leiden: Brill, 1985), p. 118, it is also present in T. Sim. 3:4, but this has not been found in the Greek text (including the variant readings).

26 The story of Joseph, the positive contrast model, speaks of his compassion and mercy.

27 See T. Sim. 2:7: 'I set my liver against him'.

28 God wishes thereby to hold him back from making a (fatal) use of his hands.

speaks to him about the wretchedness of his existence – which is a consequence of the hardening of his liver (T. Sim. 4:1).²⁹

Furthermore, the use of negative terms in paraenetic sections is completely governed by the idea of evasion (φυλάσσει, ‘beware of’, T. Sim. 3:1; 4:5)³⁰ – ‘beware of the spirits of error and envy’ (T. Sim. 3:1) or ‘of all jealousy and (all) envy’ (T. Sim. 4:5) – or, as a positive pendant, by the idea of fleeing to the Lord (T. Sim. 3:5). In the background, therefore, there is an either/or logic: the ‘spirit of envy’ on the one side against the Lord on the other side (T. Sim. 3:1–6), jealousy and envy on the one side against the singleness (ἀπλότης) of the soul on the other side (T. Sim. 4:1–6.7). The addressees must at all costs avoid any contact with the former alternative.

In the biographical-narrative passages, on the other hand, we hear of various emotions in the protagonist and of their consequences. With regard to emotions, we do not find an either/or between which the addressees must choose when they take responsibility for their own lives. Rather, we read about the effects of the emotions on the protagonist’s body and understanding (νοῦς; cf. T. Sim. 2:7), about processes of becoming conscious that are caused by his captivity (T. Sim. 4:3), by physical limitations (T. Sim. 2:12–13; cf. T. Sim. 3:4), and by his relations with God (T. Sim. 2:13–14).³¹ These are overcome in a penitential manner through prayer – namely, lamentation and petition (T. Sim. 2:13)³² – and fasting (T. Sim. 3:4), so that the body is implied here too. It is striking that these mechanisms for overcoming negative emotions are not mentioned in the specifically paraenetic sections.³³

This has an inherent communicative logic: The biographical-narrative sections have the function of showing ‘what experiences the father has gained’ (thanks to the course of his life and what has happened to him).³⁴ The reader is given the possibility of perceiving personally the reality in its boundaries and its opportunities. In the paraenetic sections, the patriarch presents the résumé

29 In the justification that links the *narratio* and the *paraenesis* in T. Sim. 4:8–9 and T. Sim. 5:1, body and soul are closely related to one another; in fact, body and soul are parallelised and interlocked at the beginning and the close of T. Sim. 4:8.

30 See Hollander and de Jonge, *Commentary*, pp. 109, 118.

31 See also the (καί) ἔργων in T. Sim. 2:13; (3:4); 4:3.

32 The request to the Lord that Simeon ‘might be restored and keep myself [Simeon] from all pollution and envy and from all folly’. Ultimately, it is therefore God who keeps him from all this; in the paraenetic exhortations, it is the addressees who must guard themselves against negative things.

33 There is no mention of μετανοία, since the addressee is meant to take the right path at once. Similarly, there is no mention of prayer or of fasting.

34 Von Nordheim, *Die Lehre der Alten*, I, p. 100.

of his life to his 'children' in an instruction about how they are to behave. The reader is directly confronted by an appeal that is strongly underlined by means of the concentration on one single emotion. In anthropological terms, first the perspective of perception, and then the perception of action is adopted.

The Testament of Dan

I

In this *Testament* about anger (θυμός) and falsehood (ψεῦδος),³⁵ the biographical-narrative section is relatively brief (T. Dan 2:4–9).³⁶ Dan speaks of his joy (ἡδόμεν, "I rejoiced") concerning the death of Joseph³⁷ and the joy of the sale of Joseph (ἔχαIRON, "I took pleasure," T. Dan 1:5). He speaks of the πνεῦμα τοῦ ζήλου καὶ τῆς ἀλαζονείας ('spirit of jealousy and self-esteem'), which told him: 'You are his [Jacob's] son as well', and of 'one of the spirits of Beliar', which 'worked with' him and demanded that he must kill Joseph with the sword (T. Dan 1:6–7). This spirit, which endeavoured to convince him, is identified as 'the spirit of anger' (τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ θυμοῦ, T. Dan 1:8).

II

In the ample paraenetic passage, Dan warns his children to 'keep' themselves 'from the spirit of falsehood and anger' (θυμοῦ) and to 'love truth and patience' (μακροθυμίαν, T. Dan 2:1). There is an explicitly negative evaluation of anger in T. Dan 3:1 (πονηρὸς ὁ θυμός), and in T. Dan 5:1, Dan directly charges his sons: 'Turn from anger and hate falsehood, that the Lord may dwell in you and Beliar may flee from you'.

III

A comparison of the biographical-narrative section and the paraenetic section in T. Dan shows that the latter concentrates on anger (θυμός) and falsehood,³⁸

35 This is the title in mss. b, (k), l, e, f. De Bruin (*Controversy*, p. 56), states correctly: 'This discussion [of the power and dangers of anger and falsehood in 5.1–3] focusses primarily on anger'.

36 Outside this section, no particular attention is paid to Dan's experiences and behaviour. See M. de Jonge, *The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs: A Critical Edition of the Greek Text* (PsVTGr I,2; Leiden: Brill 1978), p. 276.

37 See Hollander and de Jonge, *Commentary*, p. 277. In contrast to Hollander and de Jonge, J. Becker (*Die Testamente der zwölf Patriarchen* [JSHRZ III, Gütersloh: Gütersloher Verlag, 1980], p. 92) proposes that the version of manuscript β ("I rejoiced") is secondary and influenced by T. Dan 1:5.

38 With regard to the genesis of anger, T. Dan 4:6 mentions grief (λύπη).

while the narrative section once again mentions a variety of emotions: joy,³⁹ jealousy,⁴⁰ and anger.⁴¹ In the introduction (T. Dan 1:3) and in the paraenetic part, anger is explicitly characterized as 'evil' (πονηρός), but it is given 'only' an implicitly negative evaluation in the narrative part by means of its link to Beliar (T. Dan 1:7) and of the remark, which concludes the narrative section, that God did not allow Joseph to fall into Dan's hands. Dan never found him alone, and God did not permit him 'to do that wicked deed' (T. Dan 1:9). Unlike the *Testament of Simeon*, it is in the remarks in the paraenetic part of the *Testament of Dan* that psychosomatic connections are made, when we read that anger gives the body its own power (T. Dan 3:2).⁴² How is one to deal with anger? Dan charges his 'children' in the paraenetic part to 'keep' themselves 'from the spirit of falsehood and anger' (T. Dan 2:1). This exhortation is given further justification (T. Dan 2:2–5; 3:1–6). It is meant to lead to understanding (4:1, where it is once again supported by arguments). They are to observe the commandment(s) of the Lord and keep the Lord's law; they are to 'turn from anger and hate falsehood, that the Lord may dwell in you and Beliar may flee from you' (T. Dan 5:1). Dealings with anger are thus defined by an avoidance, or, more precisely, by a non-contact, based on a logic of either/or. In the narrative part, it is God who preserved Dan from carrying out an angry deed, by giving him no opportunity to kill Joseph: According to T. Dan 1:9, Dan never found Joseph alone. Here, the acting subject is *God*.

This distinction fits the communicative logic of *paraenesis*: An exhortation or instruction about conduct presumes that the *addressee* is seen as an *acting subject*.⁴³ Here, we see the juxtaposition of two possibilities of causal attribution: God or the human person is the cause of what happens. Religious texts are characterized by the fact that they offer both possibilities in juxtaposition, thereby expanding the options for dealing with emotions and thus coping with life.

On a side note, θυμός is evaluated negatively both in the biographical-narrative and in the paraenetic part of the *Testament of Dan* (T. Dan 1:3,9), but we see in the *Testament of Judah* that θυμός – in accordance with the semantic spec-

39 T. Dan 1:5 (ἔχαιρον); 1:4β (ἡδόμεν [sic]).

40 In the personification: 'the spirit of jealousy and self-esteem' (πνεῦμα τοῦ ζήλου καὶ τῆς ἀλαζονείας), T. Dan 1:6.

41 T. Dan 1:8: πνεῦμα τοῦ θυμοῦ.

42 When we read in the context that anger 'does not see', blindness is used here as a metaphor and also applies to *cognitio*. See further de Bruin, *Controversy*, pp. 152–54.

43 The situation is different in the paraenetic section in T. Jos. 10:3, where it is 'the Lord' who rescued him.

trum of θυμός – can also be evaluated as a normal reaction,⁴⁴ and can even have the positive connotation of ‘courage’. Accordingly, the patriarch relates that when he was insulted by hostile kings, he became ‘enraged’ (ἐθυμώθη) and rushed against them.⁴⁵ He and Dan attacked them ‘furiously’ (μετὰ θυμοῦ): ‘Now, we came upon them with wrath [furiously], and they all fled’ (T. Jud. 7:7). The ancient controversy about whether anger or rage was beneficial or harmful in war⁴⁶ is unambiguously resolved at this point in the *narratio* in favour of the former option. Judah is a hero.⁴⁷

*Testament of Reuben*⁴⁸

I

In the *Testament of Reuben*, the patriarch speaks about his sexual transgressions and the bodily sufferings inflicted on him⁴⁹ as a consequence of his πορνεία, and says that he did penance for seven years, practicing asceticism with regard to alcohol and food: ‘I didn’t taste any *pleasant* food’ (καὶ πᾶν ἄρτον ἐπιθυμίας οὐκ ἐγευσάμην), he says in T. Reu. 1:10.⁵⁰ Ancient lists of emotions include the

44 See also T. Levi 6:6, which relates in a completely natural tone that Jacob becomes angry (ὠργισθῆναι).

45 T. Jud. 7:5: ‘Then, being insulted, I was enraged, and I rushed against them to the summit’ (English translation here is taken from de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 195).

46 For Aristotle, *Eth. Nic.* 111:11 (1116b:22–36 – 1117a:1–9), anger (θυμός) is a constituent of courage (ἀνδρεία). According to Philodemus, *Ir.* 32:9–17, in the eyes of Peripatetics, anger is necessary for successful warfare – a view the Epicurean philosopher Philodemus does not share himself. In a similar way, Cicero describes the opinion of the Peripatetics in *Tusc.* IV:43: ‘they praise irascibility (*iracundiam laudant*) at great length; they name it the whetstone of bravery and say that the assaults of angry men upon an enemy or disloyal citizen show greater vehemence; but that there is no substance in the petty logic of those who coldly argue like this: “It is *right* to fight this battle; it is *proper* to contend for laws, for liberty, for country”; that these words have no meaning unless bravery breaks out in a blaze of anger’ (Cicero, *Tusculan Disputations*, with an English translation by J.E. King [LCL, Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1971], pp. 372–74). Seneca argues against Aristotle in *Ir.* I,VII:1–4; I,X:1–4; I,XI:1–2; I,XVII:1–2.

47 In the beginning of the *Testament of Judah*, ‘Judah may be viewed as an example of a “national hero”’ (E.M. Menn, *Judah and Tamar [Gen 38] in Ancient Jewish Exegesis: Studies in Literary Form and Hermeneutics* [JSJS, 51; Leiden: Brill, 1997], p. 134 n. 68).

48 *Paraenesis* and biographical or exemplary narratives alternate in T. Reu.; see also de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 87.

49 ‘He struck me with a foul disease in my loins’ (T. Reu. 1:7).

50 Translation by de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 88.

desire for food,⁵¹ for example in a list of vices in Philo that characterise ‘the rebels from the holy laws’.⁵² In 4 Maccabees, like sexual desire, it is a form of expression of ἡδονή, and it is certainly possible for the human person to keep it under control.⁵³ Reuben reacts to his sin with the emotion of grief: ‘I mourned (πενθῶν) over my sin’ (T. Reu. 1:10).⁵⁴ In a kind of excursus, the patriarch presents a doctrine of the seven spirits in T. Reu. 2:1b–3:8,⁵⁵ which is closely connected to the *narratio* by the repetition of the motif of youth.⁵⁶ Desire is particularly associated with being young and with young persons.⁵⁷ This is why it is included in the *narratio* here. The spirits mentioned in this passage include spirits that are closely linked to emotions: T. Reu. 2:4 mentions ‘the spirit of sight, with which desire (ἐπιθυμία) comes’.⁵⁸ T. Reu. 2:8 speaks of ‘the spirit of procreation and intercourse, with which *through love of pleasure* sin comes

51 See γαστρίμαργία in (Ps-)Andronicus περὶ παθῶν 4 = H. v. Arnim, *Chrysippi Fragmenta moralia/Fragmenta successorum Chrysippi* (SVF; Stuttgart: B.G. Teubner, 1979), vol. 3, p. 397. In their avidity, the γαστρίμαργοι overshoot the natural measure, according to Arisotle, *Eth. Nic.* 1111a3 (118b19–20).

52 Philo, *Virt.* 182 (Philo, *On the Special Laws, Book 4. On the Virtues. On Rewards and Punishments* [trans. F.H. Colson; Loeb Classical Library 341; Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1939], p. 275); see also Philo, *Spec. Leg.* 4:100–102, where God is said to have denied to the members of the sacred Commonwealth ‘all the animals of land, sea and air whose flesh is the finest and fattest, thus titillating and exciting the malignant foe pleasure (ἡδονή)’ (pp. 69–70).

53 4 Macc. 1:33–35; 2:1–3; cf. also 4 Macc. 1:27 (gluttony) and 4 Macc. 1:30b–2:23 (σωφροσύνη controls the πάθη); various desires are mentioned in these passage. On this, see P. von Gemünden, ‘Der Affekt der ἐπιθυμία und der νόμος. Affektkontrolle und soziale Identitätsbildung im Vierten Makkabäerbuch mit einem Ausblick auf den Römerbrief’, in *Affekt und Glaube. Studien zur Historischen Psychologie des Frühjudentums und Urchristentums* (NTOA, 73; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 2009), pp. 122–26).

54 See also T. Sim. 4:2: ‘I [Simeon] mourned ... because it was I who was responsible for selling Joseph’.

55 This consists of two linked lists: T. Reu. 2:3–9; 3:3–6.

56 The ‘ignorance of youth’ (ἀγνοία νεότητος, T. Reu. 1:6) is included at T. Reu. 2:2 in the ‘works of youth’, and in the ‘spirit of procreation and sexual intercourse’ as ‘the first’ among the desires of youth (πρῶτον τῆς νεότητος) and in ‘the young man’ (τὸν νεώτερον) at T. Reu. 2:9, while the ‘ignorance’ (ἐν ἀγνοίᾳ) of T. Reu. 1:6 is picked up in the ἀγνοίας of T. Reu. 2:9. The patriarch’s narration of his asceticism with regard to food at T. Reu. 1:10 is also picked up in T. Reu. 2:7 and 3:3 (‘the spirit of insatiate desire, in the stomach’). ‘The spirit of sight, with which comes desire’ (T. Reu. 2:4) is linked to seeing Bilhah (εἶδον ... Βάλλαν, T. Reu. 3:11–14).

57 See also 4 Macc. 2:1–3.

58 Translation by de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 91; see also M. Konradt, ‘“Fliehet die Unzucht” (TestRub 5,5): Sexualethische Perspektiven in den Testamenten der Zwölf Patriarchen’, in M. Konradt and E. Schläpfer (eds.), *Anthropologie und Ethik im Frühjudentum und im*

in (μεθ' ἧς συνεισέρχεται διὰ τῆς φιληδονίας ἡ ἁμαρτία);⁵⁹ and T. Reu. 3:3 of 'the spirit of insatiate desire (πνεῦμα ἀπληστίας ἐν τῇ γαστρὶ)', which is localized in the belly. T. Reu. 3:5 speaks of the 'spirit of lying in destruction and jealousy (ζήλῳ)',⁶⁰ and T. Reu. 3:6 takes up once more the concept of φιληδονία: 'the spirit of unrighteousness, with which theft and acts of rapacity come, that one may cause *love of pleasure* in one's heart (ἵνα ποιήσῃ φιληδονίαν καρδίας αὐτοῦ)'.⁶¹

In the brief biographical retrospect in T. Reu. 3:11–15 (cf. Gen. 35:22), Reuben describes the impact that seeing the naked Bilhah has on his thinking (διάνοια): He cannot sleep until the opportunity presents itself and he has intercourse with Bilhah.⁶² When an angel reveals this to his father, Jacob reacts with the emotion of grief in T. Reu. 3:15: 'he [Jacob] mourned over me [ἐπένθει ἐπ' ἐμοί]'.

In T. Reu. 4:8–9, the patriarch points to Joseph as a positive example and tells how he guarded himself against every woman. Despite the stratagems of the Egyptian woman, 'the disposition of his soul did not admit an evil desire (ἐπιθυμίαν πονηράν)' (T. Reu. 3:10).⁶³

II

In the paraenetic sections, Reuben exhorts his 'children' 'not to live your lives in the ignorance of youth and give yourselves up to fornication (πορνεία)' (T. Reu. 1:6), to love the truth (T. Reu. 3:9), to 'pay no attention to a woman's face', not to be alone together with the wife of another man, and not to get involved in women's matters (T. Reu. 3:10);⁶⁴ they are to 'pay no attention to women's beauty' (T. Reu. 4:1; cf. T. Reu. 5:1–5). His exhortations culminate in the warning: 'Beware, then, of fornication (πορνεία) ... For indulgence in fornication allows no scope for either understanding or godliness for impurity (πορνεία) has neither understanding nor piety in itself, and all jealousy (ζήλος) dwells in its desire (ἐπιθυμία)' (T. Reu. 6:1–4).

Neuen Testament (WUNT, 322; Tübingen: Mohr, 2014), p. 265 including n. 77 (cf. also *T. Reu.* 5:3b).

59 Translation by de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 91.

60 Translation by de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 91.

61 Translation by Hollander and de Jonge, *Commentary*, pp. 91–92. See also *T. Reu.* 2:8.

62 See I. Rosen-Zvi, 'Bilhah the Temptress: The Testament of Reuben and the "Birth of Sexuality"', *JQR* 96.1 (2006), pp. 65–94. In *T. Reu.* 3:11–15 (unlike its 'parallel' in Jubilees 33), the emphasis lies (1) on the διάνοια, which is influenced by the sight of the naked Bilhah, and (2) on the thoughts influenced by this sight, which precede the action (Konradt, "Fliehet die Unzucht", p. 252). This is why *T. Reu.* 4:1 also exhorts: 'Pay no attention, therefore, to women's beauty'.

63 Translation by de Jonge, *Testaments*, p. 97.

64 See Konradt, "Fliehet die Unzucht", pp. 269–70.

III

If we now compare the biographical-narrative sections with the paraenetic sections, we note the striking concentration in the *paraenesis* on πορνεία and on the warning against women (and their beauty). In the paraenetic context, emotions are explicitly mentioned only in the justification of the concluding exhortation in T. Reu. 6:4: πᾶς ζήλος κατοικεῖ ἐν τῇ ἐπιθυμίᾳ αὐτῆς ('all jealousy dwells in its desire').⁶⁵ In the biographical-narrative sections, on the other hand, more space is given to the emotions. We hear most frequently of ἐπιθυμία,⁶⁶ of φιληδονία,⁶⁷ of reactive grief (mourning),⁶⁸ and of ζήλος (jealousy).⁶⁹ Πορνεία is presented as the consequence of the sight that provokes desire (cf. T. Reu. 3:11–14 conjointly with T. Reu. 2:4.8) and as the imprint that desire has on thinking (διάνοια) (T. Reu. 3:12). It has bodily consequences: Reuben had 'a foul disease' in his loins (T. Reu. 1:7; cf. 1:8).⁷⁰ Penance is done by means of asceticism with regard to alcohol and food, as well as through grief. This means that the process of coping also involves the body (T. Reu. 1:10).⁷¹ The exhortations take a different line: their goal is escape (φεύγετε, T. Reu 5:5), being on one's guard and 'beware' (φυλάσσεσθε, T. Reu. 6:1), or prophylactic measures of avoidance (T. Reu. 5:5).⁷² In each case, therefore, a non-contact intended to ward off in advance the fornication that Reuben himself committed. The ascetic measures of coping in T. Reu. 1:10 are not found in the paraenetic sections,⁷³ nor is intercession by a third party.⁷⁴ In T. Reuben, the antithetical possibilities of the two genres

65 An identical translation is given in de Jonge, *Testaments*, p.102.

66 T. Reu. 1:10 (pleasant food); 2:4 (spirit of sight, with which desire comes); 4:9 (the disposition of Joseph's soul did not admit an evil desire).

67 T. Reu. 2:8; 3:6.

68 T. Reu. 1:10 (Reuben's reactive grief); T. Reu. 3:15b (grief of Reuben's father).

69 T. Reu. 3:5.

70 In the background lies the idea that 'one is punished by the very things by which one sins' (Wis. 11:6). See also T. Gad 5:10: 'For by what things a man transgresses, by the same he is also punished' (cf. *Jubilees* 4:31–32; *LAB* 44:10).

71 Another positive factor is Jacob's prayer of intercession to God for his son, see T. Reu. 1:7b; T. Reu. 4:4.

72 The wives and daughters are not to decorate their heads and faces to lead men's minds astray.

73 Among the Greeks and Romans and the desert fathers, asceticism with regard to alcohol and food also served to check sexual urges and thus bring sexuality under control. See A. Rousselle, *Porneia: Da la maîtrise du corps à la privation sensorielle. 11^e–IV^e siècles de l'ère chrétienne* (Paris: Presses Universitaires de France 1983), pp. 16, 32, 101, 185, 192, 216–18. See also T. Jos. 3:4–5; 4:8; 9:2 (cf. H.W. Hollander, *Joseph as an Ethical Model in the Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* [SVTP, 6; Leiden: Brill, 1981], pp. 33–38); see also perhaps Rom. 13:14.

74 Jacob intercedes for his son in the narrative sections, see T. Reu. 1:7b; 4:4.

can be seen very clearly. The narrative speaks realistically of Reuben's moral lapse and relates in great detail how God makes a new beginning possible for him through repentance and conversion. On the other hand, the *paraenesis* demands, in an almost unrealistic manner, that one keep one's distance from every *πορνεία*.

New Testament

In the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*, we read about emotions in a self-contained textual corpus belonging to the macrogenre 'testament' or 'farewell discourse', with both narrative and paraenetic sections (followed by prophetic declarations about the future). In the New Testament, we must draw a distinction (apart from the Revelation of John)⁷⁵ between two other macrogenres: the Gospel literature and the epistolary literature. This means that we start from a more disparate situation. Nevertheless, in these macrogenres too, we can observe a different evaluation of emotions in the narrative and the paraenetic contexts.⁷⁶ Let me demonstrate this with the examples of envy, anger, and desire, emotions that figured prominently in the paraenetic passages of the *Testaments of Simeon, Dan, and Reuben*.

'Envy' (φθόνος)

I

The keyword φθόνος ('envy') occurs in a narrative context in the New Testament only in Mark 15:10 // Matt. 27:18.⁷⁷ In the context of the story about Barabbas,

75 The third great New Testament macrogenre, the Revelation of John, could not be included in our investigation for reasons of space.

76 Further differentiations among the Gospels and the different letters would be interesting. But that is a task for the future. Some observations can already be found in P. von Gemünden, 'Affekte in den synoptischen Evangelien: Die Bedeutung der literarischen Gattung für die Darstellung von Zorn, Begierde, Furcht/Angst und Neid', in P. v. Gemünden, D. Horrell and M. Küchler (eds.), *Jesus-Gestalt und Gestaltungen. Rezeptionen des Galiläers in Wissenschaft, Kirche und Gesellschaft. Festschrift für Gerd Theißen zum 70. Geburtstag* (NTOA, 100; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht 2013), pp. 256–67, 273–77. Our focus in the present article is on emotions and genres.

77 In antiquity, φθόνος (envy) is very closely associated with ὀφθαλμός πονηρός ('evil eye'); see P. v. Gemünden, 'Affekte in den synoptischen Evangelien', p. 273 n. 118. We find the evil eye in the narrative context of the parable of the workers in the vineyard in Matt. 20:15b, where the master asks the grumbling worker: 'Is your eye evil because I am good?' Here, as in Mark 15:10, the envy is 'diagnosed' from the outside.

the narrator comments:⁷⁸ 'For he [Pilate] knew that the chief priests [and elders, Matt. 27:18]⁷⁹ had handed him [Jesus] over to him out of envy (διὰ φθόνου)' (Mark 15:10).

Although nothing in the text itself prepares for this,⁸⁰ Pilate, according to Mark, recognises the inner motivation behind what the chief priests do:⁸¹ namely, φθόνος ('envy'). Here, we have a perception or interpretation from outside the character of Pilate, but the inner motivation becomes clear in John 12:19, where the Pharisees say to one another instead of to Pilate: 'You see, you can do nothing; all the world has gone after him'.⁸² The Gospel of John does not indeed speak explicitly of envy, but according to ancient psychology, envy was generated by comparing oneself with others.⁸³

In Mark's account, envy drives the chief priests to stir up the people (ἀνέσεισαν τὸν ὄχλον) – that is to say, to elicit negative feelings – so that the people, instead of answering Pilate's questions, demand that Jesus be crucified (Mark 15:11–15). The narrative depicts here how envy lead to negative actions that have an unjust outcome.⁸⁴

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- 78 Lohmeyer interprets the commentary as an insertion by Mark; see E. Lohmeyer, *Das Evangelium des Markus* (KEK, I.2; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 17th edn, 1967), p. 338. The commentary in Mark 15:10 is said to be by Mark himself or 'die ihm vorgegebene Passionsgeschichte' (D. Lührmann, *Das Markusevangelium* [HNT, 3; Tübingen: J.C.B. Mohr, 1987], p. 256:).
- 79 On this, see U. Luz, *Das Evangelium nach Matthäus* (Matt. 26–28) (EKK, I.4; Neukirchen-Vluyn: Neukirchener Verlag, 2002), p. 272 n. 43.
- 80 No motivation is given in Mark for the envy itself.
- 81 Matthew has in mind the chief priests and elders; see U. Luz, *Evangelium*, p. 272 n. 43.
- 82 Dio Chrysostom argues in his discourse on envy in favour of its complete absence, since, in the words of K.-H. Nusser's summary of Dio's justification of this notion, 'the glory from one's fellow human beings is derived from opinions of the many, but these scarcely make an objective judgment' ('dass der Ruhm von Mitmenschen auf die Meinungen der Menge zurückgeht, diese aber kaum sachkundig urteilt', K.-H. Nusser, 'Neid', in J. Ritter et al. (eds.), *Historisches Wörterbuch der Philosophie* [Basel: Schwabe, 1984], vol. 6, p. 697).
- 83 According to Aristotle, envy is directed to persons who are one's equal, who are similar and close to oneself (Aristotle, *Rh.* 2:10 [1387b23–27], 2:10 [1388a5–7]), but also to those who are one's rivals (2:10 [1388a7–17]); see E. Sanders, 'Aristotle and the Rhetoric of Phthonos', in I. Sluiter and R.M. Rosen (eds.), *Kakos: Badness and Anti-Value in Classical Antiquity* (Mn.Suppl., 307; Leiden: Brill, 2008), pp. 270–71.
- 84 In Aristotle's view, 'If phthonos ... does not remain a mere state of mind, but becomes effective as the motive for an action that of its nature is directed against someone else, it contributes to (natural) injustice'; see E. Milobenski, *Der Neid in der griechischen Philosophie* (KPS, 29; Wiesbaden: Harrasowitz, 1964), p. 85; Nusser, *Historisches Wörterbuch der Philosophie*, vol. 6, p. 697.

II

In the epistolary literature, we encounter human φθόνος in catalogues of vices (Rom. 1:29; Gal. 5:21; 1 Tim. 6:4; Tit. 3:3; 1 Pet. 2:1).⁸⁵ The vices are presented in the form of a contrast, predominantly in a paraenetic context. On the one hand, we have the pagan, 'pre-Christian past' that is characterized by vices; on the other hand, we have the Christian present that is characterized by virtues.⁸⁶ The works of the flesh are contrasted with the fruits of the Spirit (Gal. 5:19–22), and the vices that are ascribed to the teachers of error (including φθόνος) form a contrast to the virtues of the orthodox office-bearer.⁸⁷ Here, the logic of the 'either/or' holds sway, but there is no concentration on *one* particular vice.

III

In the narrative context, envy illuminates the motivation of an action. Here, the consequences of envy also become clear, and the reader sees the disastrous effects of this emotion; to some extent, the terrible continuation of the story is 'explained'. In a paraenetic context, envy (accompanied by, or associated with, other emotions and vices) characterizes only the pre- or non-Christian or heretical existence, in contrast to the Christian existence with its positive connotations.

85 The catalogue of vices in Mark 7:21–22 (i.e., within the Gospel literature) mentions ὀφθαλμὸς πονηρός. In the logion Matt. 6:22–23 // Luke 11:34–36, the 'pure eye [without envy]' (ὀφθαλμὸς ἀπλοῦς) is contrasted with the 'evil eye (ὀφθαλμὸς πορηρός)'. Referring to the work of D.L. Cairns, N. Fisher and S. Saïd, D. Konstan and N.K. Rutter comment that envy 'might be viewed, at least in some contexts, as a morally responsive and hence positive emotion' ('Introduction', in D. Konstan and N.K. Rutter [eds.], *Envy, Spite and Jealousy: The Rivalrous Emotions in Ancient Greece* [Edinburgh Leventis Studies, 2; Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press, 2003], pp. 4–5; cf. D.L. Cairns, 'The Politics of Envy: Envy and Equality in Ancient Greece', in Konstan and Rutter [eds.], *Envy, Spite and Jealousy*, pp. 235–52; N. Fisher, '“Let Envy Be Absent”: Envy Liturgies and Reciprocity in Athens', in Konstan and Rutter [eds.], *Envy, Spite and Jealousy*, pp. 181–215; S. Saïd, 'Envy and Emulation in Isocrates', in Konstan and Rutter [eds.], *Envy, Spite and Jealousy*, pp. 217–34). This is neither the case in the *Testament of Simeon* nor in the New Testament.

86 The ascription to the Gentiles or to the existence *ante fidem* can coalesce; see Rom. 1:29–31. The ποτέ – νῦν–scheme, which clearly determines Tit. 3:3–11, also lies behind 1 Pet. 2:1 and probably behind Rom. 1:20–31; on the latter passage, see U. Wilckens, *Der Brief an die Römer* (Röm. 1–5) (ΕΚΚ, 6.1; Neukirchen-Vluyn: Neukirchener Verlag, 2nd edn, 1987), p. 112.

87 See the use of φθόνος in 1 Tim. 6:4 in the catalogue of vices that characterize the heretical teachers (1 Tim. 6:3–10), in contrast to the orthodox office-bearer who is given the title 'person of God' (1 Tim. 6:11) and is associated with a catalogue of virtues.

'Anger' (ὀργή)

I

In a narrative context, the keyword 'anger' (ὀργή) occurs in Mark 3:5 in relation to Jesus, when we are told that Jesus looks at the Pharisees, filled 'with anger' (μετ' ὀργῆς) and grief.⁸⁸ It is obvious that Jesus' anger is presupposed in the narrative of his cursing of the fig tree (Mark 11:12–14 // Matt. 21:18–19) and of his action in the temple (Mark 11:15–19 // John 2:14–16), although the keyword is not explicitly used.⁸⁹ We read in the parable of the prodigal son (although it would be better to speak of *two* lost sons) that the older brother of the prodigal son became angry (ὀργισθῆναι) when he heard that his father had laid out a feast for his brother on his return, and had slaughtered the fatted calf (Luke 15:28).⁹⁰ In the parable of the merciless creditor, we read in Matt. 18:34 that the king is angry with his slave (καὶ ὀργισθεὶς ὁ κύριος αὐτοῦ) who has behaved without mercy towards his fellow slave, although he himself had earlier received much greater mercy from his master. Finally, the parable of the great feast speaks of the king's anger⁹¹ when his invitation to the meal is refused (Matt. 22:7 // Luke 14:21). Here, anger appears as a normal reaction.

II

In the epistolary literature, we find human ὀργή in a paraenetic context mostly in catalogues of vices.⁹² Since anger is inappropriate to the Christian way of life, it must be laid aside (Col. 3:8) or banished from among Christians (Eph. 5:31). The binary antithesis is made clear by the ποτε – νυνὶ δέ in Col. 3:7–8 (cf. Eph. 2:3). In 1 Tim. 2:8, men are exhorted to raise 'holy hands' (in prayer) χωρὶς ὀργῆς ('without anger'). In the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus equates anger with murder (Matt. 5:21–22). In other words, he condemns it as strongly as possible.

88 ὀργισθεὶς is found in the Western text of Mark 1:41. We read ἀγανακτέω, which is weaker than ὀργή, in Mark 10:14, where Jesus reacts with displeasure to the disciples who turn away the people who want to bring their children to him. The verb ἀγανακτέω is used of the disciples in Mark 10:41 // Matt. 20:24, as well as in Mark 14:4 // Matt. 26:8.

89 On this, see von Gemünden, *Affekte*, p. 260.

90 Here, the anger of the intertextual addressees (Luke 15:2) and possibly also the extratextual addressees is taken up into the parable by means of 'Verschränkung' or 'interlocking'; see E. Linnemann, *Gleichnisse Jesu. Einführung und Auslegung* [Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 3rd edn, 1964], pp. 34–34, 86).

91 Luke 14:21 speaks not of a king (βασιλεύς, as in Matt. 22:7) but of the master of a house (οἰκοδεσπότης).

92 See Col. 3:8 (ὀργή, θυμός); Eph. 4:31 (θυμός καὶ ὀργή). Galatians 5:20 mentions θυμός.

III

Once again, we observe a tension. In the *narratio*, we read about the emotion of anger – even about Jesus’s anger – as something taken for granted, but in a par-aenetic context, anger is strongly condemned and presented as something incompatible with Christian life.⁹³

‘Desire’ (ἐπιθυμία)

I

In a narrative context, we do not find ἐπιθυμία in the sense of *concupiscentia*, although it is presupposed in the narrative of the woman taken in adultery⁹⁴, who, according to John 7:53–8:11, is to be stoned. One can (but need not) read the narrative of the woman who was ‘a great sinner’ in Luke 7:36–50 with erotic overtones.⁹⁵ In these two narratives, Jesus’s attitude to the women is not strictly negative. He tells the adulteress at John 8:11: ‘Neither do I condemn you. Go; do not sin again’. And he allows the so-called ‘great sinner’ in Luke to draw near to him, and finally tells her that her many sins are forgiven.

93 But see also the quotation in Eph. 4:26: ‘Be angry but do not sin! Do not let the sun go down on your wrath’. This, however, is embedded in a context of laying aside anger (Eph. 4:25) or being far from anger (Eph. 4:31). In Jas 1:19, the author warns against being ‘quick to anger’, but the author makes it clear with the justification that ‘the angry person does not do that which is right (before God).’

94 We read in Exod. 20:14 LXX/Deut. 5:18 LXX: ‘Οὐκ ἐπιθυμήσεις τὴν γυναῖκα τοῦ πλησίον σου’. The prohibition of adultery (Exod. 20:14 LXX/Deut. 5:18 LXX) is intensified in Matt. 5:28: πᾶς ὁ βλέπων γυναῖκα πρὸς τὸ ἐπιθυμήσαι αὐτὴν ἤδη ἐμοίχευσεν αὐτὴν ἐν τῇ καρδίᾳ αὐτοῦ; and the formulation shows influence from Exod. 20:17 LXX/Deut. 5:21 LXX. Here we explicitly see a connection between ἐπιθυμία/ἐπιθυμεῖν and adultery. Compare also Prov. 6:24–29; Sus 32 (in connection with Sus 37) and implicitly Epictetus, *Diatr.* 11: 18.15–18 (note the context); 4 Macc. 2:4–6 (here Exod. 20:17 LXX on the one hand refers to Joseph and the wife of Potiphar [4 Macc. 2:2–3] but on the other hand prepares a generalisation; see H.-J. Klauck, 4. *Makkabäerbuch* [JSHRZ, III.6; Gütersloh: Gütersloher Verlagshaus, 1989], p. 695 n. 5a). In Philo, *Spec. Leg.* 4:84, covetousness is the source of all evils, including adultery. See also LAE 19 (*ApMos* 19), where we read in the context of the fall that ἐπιθυμία – or, in the translation given by M.D. Johnson, ‘covetousness’ – is the origin of every sin’ (‘Life of Adam and Eve’, in J.H. Charlesworth [ed.], *The Old Testament Pseudepigrapha* [New York: Doubleday, 1985], vol. 2, p. 279 including n. 19d). The Greek words ἐπιθυμία/ἐπιθυμεῖν can also be used in a more general way; see also Rom. 7:7; Jas 1:15 (ἐπιθυμία ... τίκτει ἁμαρτίαν). The passage John 7:53–8:11 can be understood as an example of mortal sins, so ‘a woman caught in adultery’ functions ‘as an example of the so-called “mortal sins”’ (M. Theobald, *Das Evangelium nach Johannes, Kapitel 1–12. Übersetzt und erklärt* (RNT; Regensburg: Verlag Friedrich Pustet, 2009), p. 556).

95 See von Gemünden, *Affekte*, p. 266, including n. 77.

II

However, Jesus makes a paraenetic intensification of the prohibition of adultery through his words: 'But I say to you: Whoever looks at a woman to desire her (πρὸς τὸ ἐπιθυμῆσαι αὐτήν) has already committed adultery with her in his heart' (Matt. 5:27–28). In other words, the lustful look is equated with adultery.⁹⁶ In the *paraenesis* within epistolary literature, ἐπιθυμία⁹⁷ is ascribed to the pre-Christian (and/or the non-Christian) existence, as in Gal. 5:16: 'Walk by the Spirit, and do not gratify the desires of the flesh';⁹⁸ and Gal. 5:24: 'Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires'. Romans 13:14 refers clearly back to baptism, when we read: 'Let us conduct ourselves becomingly, not ... in debauchery and licentiousness (μὴ κοίταις καὶ ἀσελείαις) ... but put on the Lord Jesus Christ, and make no provision for the flesh, to gratify its desires (ἐπιθυμίας)' (Rom. 13:13–14). When Eph. 2:3 speaks of the 'desires of the flesh', this is located or inscribed in the contrast between 'then' (ποτε) and 'now' (νῦν).

III

While the 'desires' are strongly condemned in the context of *paraenesis*, and even a lustful look is equated with adultery, the Lukan Jesus is less dismissive or negative over against the 'great sinner'; and the same is true of Jesus in the story transmitted in John 7:53–8:11 over against the woman taken in adultery. This may be connected with the fact that it is not men who are the centre of interest here (as in Matt. 5:27–28) but women, who are societally weaker and disadvantaged.⁹⁹ A further element may, however, be the role played by the genre itself.

Conclusion

We can sum up our observations on the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* and the New Testament in three points.

96 Von Gemünden, *Affekte*, pp. 264–65.

97 In what follows, I pay attention only to the use of ἐπιθυμία in the sense of *concupiscentia*.

98 It is difficult to evaluate Gal. 5:17, because there the desire of the flesh is directed against the spirit, and the desire of the spirit against the flesh. See H.D. Betz, *Galatians: A Commentary on Paul's Letter to the Churches in Galatia* (Philadelphia, PA: Fortress, 1979), pp. 457–79.

99 See G. Theißen, 'Frauen im Umfeld Jesu', *Jesus als historische Gestalt: Beiträge zur Jesusforschung. Zum 60. Geburtstag von G. Theißen* (ed. A. Merz; FRLANT, 202; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 2003), p. 103.

First, it is clear that it is easier to make use of the plurality of the emotions within the *narratio*. One reason for this may be that the text tends to speak of several persons,¹⁰⁰ who also interact with one another. In the *paraenesis*, on the other hand, we can observe the tendency in the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* to concentrate on *one* emotion.¹⁰¹ In the New Testament epistles, the emotion is often found in the list of a catalogue of vices.¹⁰²

Second, the *narratio* offers the opportunity to perceive and evaluate emotions in a more differentiated manner.¹⁰³ A variety of perspectives are possible, not only the external and internal perspectives of the characters but also those of the omniscient narrator.¹⁰⁴ In the *paraenesis*, on the other hand, a figure of authority speaks to the addressees. Here, the dualistic antithesis plays a dominant role, either by contrasting various emotions with one another or by contrasting catalogues of vices and catalogues of virtues.

Third, psychosomatic connections are sometimes made explicit in the *narratio*.¹⁰⁵ Mechanisms of explanation¹⁰⁶ and of coping with problems can be seen here.¹⁰⁷ In paraenetic texts, on the other hand, the exhortation to take

100 And with a variety of perspectives!

101 For instance, note the concentration on jealousy in the *Testament of Simeon*, on anger in the *Testament of Dan*, and on *πῶρεια* (and on the desire that lies behind it) in the *Testament of Reuben*. This concentration on one single emotion, each of which is ascribed *par excellence* to one particular patriarch, allows us to see one compositional principle of the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*. As P.H. Aschermann (*Die paränetischen Formen der 'Testamente der zwölf Patriarchen' und ihr Nachwirken in der frühchristlichen Mahnung. Eine formgeschichtliche Untersuchung* [Ph.D. diss., Humboldt University Berlin, 1955], p. 26) states, 'These biographical accounts then provide the keyword for the *paraenesis*, which treats of one particular theme in each Testament' ('*Aus diesen biographischen Berichten ergibt sich dann das Stichwort für die Paränese, die in jedem Testament ein bestimmtes Thema abhandelt*').

102 Or also in a catalogue of virtues.

103 In the *Testament of Judah*, anger (*θυμός*) can in fact have positive connotations too; see *T. Jud.* 7:5-7.

104 For example, we have Pilate noting the jealousy of the chief priests, the retrospective introspection of the patriarchs, as well as an omniscient narrator ('Then he [the elder son] became angry', *Luke* 15:28).

105 So in the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*; see *T. Sim.* 2:6-7 (12-13); 3:2-3; 4:1.8; 5:1; *T. Reu.* 1:6-8.

106 *T. Sim.* 2:13-14; 3:2; 4:2-3; *T. Reu.* 1:7-8. Demonological explanations can also be seen in paraenetic sections; see *T. Sim.* 2:5; 4:7.9; 5:1; *T. Reu.* 2:1b-3:8.

107 *The Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs* mention penance, prayer, fasting, love, compassion (*T. Sim.* 3:4) and intercession by a close relative (*T. Reu.* 4:4). In the New Testament, one finds forgiveness of sins or changing one's way of life ('From now on do not sin again').

evasive action dominates. Here, the emotion is not to be mastered. Rather, against the background of a harsh either/or logic, non-contact is required: 'Be on your guard against this or that negative emotion!'

In each case, a specific perspective is presupposed. The *narratio* concentrates on characters who are affected by emotions, while the *paraenesis* addresses children¹⁰⁸ or newborn Christians¹⁰⁹ who are not to fall into the trap of disastrous emotions.

How can these differences be explained?

We have repeatedly found one initial explanation in the possibilities that are specific to the individual genres:¹¹⁰ Narrative texts have a relationship to the past,¹¹¹ which implies an element of distancing.¹¹² Narrative texts also display a sequence of events in time, with references to unique circumstances of place

108 They are to avoid the errors of the patriarch and learn from his experience of life.

109 See the frequent reference to conversion or baptism in the context of passions and emotions in the New Testament.

110 That there is a relationship between the literary genre and the presentation of emotions can be confirmed by a comparison of Seneca's tragedies with Seneca's philosophical letters. On the one hand, he maintains the Stoic ideal of freedom from emotion when a beloved person dies (e.g., Seneca, *Ep.* 85 and *Ep.* 99); on the other hand, we read about very vehement reactions of grief in his tragedies (e.g., Seneca, *Tro.* 98–132; *Tro.* 787–799). The differences between the tragedies and the philosophical letters are so great that for a long time it was a widespread opinion that Seneca tragicus and Seneca philosophus were two different persons. Today it is clear: 'Seneca tragicus and Seneca philosophus are ... the same person' (S.E. Fischer, 'Systematic connections between Seneca's Philosophical Works and Tragedies', in G. Damschen and A. Heil [eds.], *Brill's Companion to Seneca: Philosopher and Dramatist* [Leiden: Brill, 2014], pp. 745–46]). Interestingly, the differences between Seneca's tragedies and his philosophy are often explained by the 'diverse genres' (Fischer, 'Systematic connections', p. 746). The observations of L.C.A. Alexander ('The Passions in Galen and the Novels of Chariton and Xenophon', in J.T. Fitzgerald [ed.], *Passions and Moral Progress in Greco-Roman Thought* [London and New York: Routledge, 2008], pp. 175–97) point in the same direction.

111 J. Roloff has investigated this tendency; see J. Roloff, *Das Kerygma und der irdische Jesus: Historische Motive in den Jesus-Erzählungen der Evangelien* (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1970); see also the summary of this book in R. Bultmann, *Geschichte der synoptischen Tradition: Ergänzungsheft* (ed. by G. Theissen and Ph. Vielhauer; Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 5th edn, 1979), p. 10; and H. Weder, *Neutestamentliche Hermeneutik* (ZGB; Zurich: Theologischer Verlag, 2nd edn, 1989), pp. 391–95. The relationship of a narrative to the past can, of course, also be fictitious.

112 The reader can find himself or herself in the narrative (via identification or demarcation) and clarify his or her own identity: 'Who am I? Who do I want to be?' See D. Ritschl, *Zur Logik der Theologie: Kurze Darstellung der Zusammenhänge theologischer Grundgedanken* (Munich: Chr. Kaiser Verlag, 1984), p. 45. A narrative can, of course, also have the function

and time. Paraenetic texts, on the other hand, speak directly to the present and aim at the future. They lack the distancing effect of the *narratio*. This is why *paraenesis* usually has a general validity that is applicable to many situations and concrete circumstances; it has the character of an appeal.

A second explanation looks to the communicative logic of the text. The reader who is implicitly presupposed in the text is addressed in different ways. Narrative texts present emotions (and their effects) in a differentiated manner appropriate to *narration*; they invite the reader to reflection. Paraenetic texts, on the other hand, lack the distance of the *narratio*. They intend to have a direct impact on the present and the future of the addressees and to summon them to make a decision. The catchphrase-like listing or mentioning of the emotions corresponds to their character as an appeal. This is reduced to alternatives within an either-or logic. It is not a question of the differentiated representation of experiences (whereby one shares in the event that is described through the distance of the *narratio*), but of a clear decision for or against an option. That is why we can observe that there is a clear distinction between the realism of the narratives and the unambiguousness of the *paraenesis*.

A third level of explanation concerns the anthropological basis of these differences between the presentation of emotions in *narratio* and in *paraenesis*. Every genre is a way of looking at the world from one particular perspective. Human beings have the capacity for multiperspectivity. People tend towards different types of attribution of causality in different situations. Sometimes, they explain their emotions by referring to external factors (such as spirits); sometimes, they attribute them to their own person. Sometimes, people are overwhelmed by feelings; sometimes, they control them. Some texts, such as the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*, oscillate between the two. In other texts, as in the New Testament, they are often juxtaposed in different macro-genres. The reason for this multiperspectivity is our need to react differently in different situations. At one time, we need the narrative realism that tolerates the plurality and the contradictions; at another time, we need the paraenetic unambiguousness that helps us to make a commitment for and against something. The plurality of genres is based on the multiperspectivity of human beings. What the Letter to the Hebrews says of the Word of God is true also of human language: It is spoken πολυμερῶς καὶ πολυτρόπως (Heb. 1:1).

of an appeal. But it appeals not directly but only indirectly – for example, via the figure of the protagonist.